ScrollGuard Annotation Guide

Independent labeling for benchmark validation · about 40-60 minutes

Rules

1. Label **alone**. Do not discuss cases with the other annotator or the team until you submit.
2. Use **only** the sheet you received. Do not open other files in the repository (especially `benchmark_labels.csv` and `benchmark_meta*.csv`).
3. There is no time pressure per case, but do not go back and change many answers at the end. Your first careful judgment is what we need.
4. Some rows look almost identical and differ only in a few numeric columns (for example swipe values). This is intentional. Label each row on its own.

1. Your task

Each row describes one moment of someone's smartphone use. Imagine you are ScrollGuard, an assistant that should **not disturb intentional use** and should **gently step in only when the person seems to be scrolling on autopilot**. Choose one action per row and write it in the `annotator_action` column.

Write exactly	Meaning
`no_intervention`	Intentional or normal use. Do nothing.
`gentle_prompt`	Autopilot use. Without blocking, fade the screen to grayscale and show a small pop-up or voice (TTS) check-in. The person can always continue.
`ask_context`	Signals conflict, or key information is missing. Ask what the person is trying to do.

2. Columns

Column	Meaning
`time_of_day`, `entry_trigger`, `app_type`	Current time; how the app was opened (self_open / notification / search); kind of app.
`user_stated_goal`	What the person typed when ScrollGuard asked for a goal. If they gave none, the reason is shown in brackets (skipped, turned off, closed the window).
`user_state`	Who the person is, what kind of day it is, and where they are / what they are doing right now.
`recent_context`	An observation log in 5 parts: **Entry** (how the app was opened) | **In app** (what happened inside the app) | **App switches** | **Interactions** (counts of searches, saves, likes, comments) | **Schedule/settings** (calendar, bedtime goal, timers). It lists only what was observed. **Usually the most important column.**
`usage_minutes` … `usage_quadratic`	Usage in the last 60 minutes, number of sessions, median session length (sec), usage concentration (0-1).
`swipe_interval_cv`, `avg_dwell_sec`	How uniform the swipes are (lower = more regular) and average seconds per item. Empty if the app has no scrolling.
`self_reported_mood`, `typical_usage_minutes`	Mood the person reported (1-6, higher = better) and their usual phone use per hour (median minutes from their other records). Both are real values from the source dataset.

3. Decision criteria

Action	Choose it when
`no_intervention`	Behavior matches the stated goal, **or** goal-directed actions are observed (searching, saving, writing, editing, paying, switching to a related app), **or** short utility use (maps, messages, music), **or** use within a time limit the person set.
`gentle_prompt`	**Two or more** independent autopilot signals **and** no evidence of a purpose. Signals: no goal-directed action at all; drifting into a feed after a notification or after finishing a task; going past a stated goal, timer or bedtime; use that conflicts with the schedule; repeatedly reopening or refreshing.
`ask_context`	Purpose signals and drifting signals both appear, **or** key information is blocked while the usage is notable. When a wrong intervention seems likely, asking is better.

Boundary rules

- Respect explicit declarations (e.g. "I want to watch tonight's live football match").
- **Numbers alone are not enough.** Long usage, late night, or regular swipes do not by themselves mean autopilot; base your decision on what the person was doing.
- Exceeding a time limit is one signal, not two.
- Very short use (1-3 minutes) with little information: `no_intervention`, not a question.

4. Suggested order

1. Read `user_stated_goal` and `recent_context` first.
2. Is there a clear purpose (goal matched, goal-directed actions, short utility, self-set limit)? → `no_intervention`
3. Are there 2+ autopilot signals and no purpose? → `gentle_prompt`
4. Mixed signals, or key information blocked? → `ask_context`
5. Use the numbers only to support what the text shows.

5. How to fill and submit

1. Open the CSV in Excel or Google Sheets. If text looks broken in Excel, use *Data → From Text/CSV* and choose **UTF-8**.
2. Fill **all 81 rows** of `annotator_action` with one of the three values, spelled exactly. Do not change any other cell or the row order.
3. Save as **CSV UTF-8** with the file name you were given (`annot_a.csv` or `annot_b.csv`) and send it back.

Thank you! Your answers are compared with the other annotator and with the designers' labels (Cohen's kappa) to check whether the labels are clear enough. There are no right or wrong annotators.